

Calculating the probabilities for events having equally likely outcomes.

▮ A pregnancy yields a baby :

$$\Omega = \{ \text{boy, girl} \}$$

▮ Tossing a fair coin :

$$\Omega = \{ \text{head, tail} \}$$

▮ Rolling a 6-sided dice :

$$\Omega = \{ 1, 2, 3, \dots, 6 \}$$

THM. If the Ω contains n equally likely w 's, and each w has prob of $\frac{1}{n}$ being selected. Then $P(A) = \frac{|A|}{|\Omega|}$, where $|A| = \#$ of w 's in A .

Ex. Roll a 6-sided dice once.
What is the prob of having the
result < 3 ?

$$\therefore \Omega = \{1, 2, 3, \dots, 6\}$$

$$\text{and } A = \{1, 2\}$$

$$\therefore P(\{i\}) = \frac{1}{6}$$

$$\therefore P(A) = \frac{|A|}{|\Omega|} = \frac{2}{6} = \frac{1}{3}.$$

Review of counting principles

▢ The fundamental principle of counting

- suppose a task
- want to find out the # of ways to complete the task
- separate the task into k stages
- in each stage, there are $n_1, n_2, \dots, n_k$ # of ways to complete the sub-task.
- the total # of ways to complete the original task $= n_1 \times n_2 \times \dots \times n_k$

Ex. Toss 3 different 6-sided dices.

What is the # of w's in Ω ?

$$|\Omega| = \boxed{6} \times \boxed{6} \times \boxed{6}$$

1st 2nd 3rd

$$= 6^3$$

Ex. Place 3 different books on the shelf of a book case.

$$\# \text{ of placement} = \boxed{3} \times \boxed{2} \times \boxed{1}$$

1st 2nd 3rd

$$= 6$$

Permutation : An ordered arrangement of k objects out of n objects.

— When ~~repetition~~ ^{repetition} is allowed, then the # of ways to complete the task = n^k

(e.g. in the dice example, $n=6$, $k=3$)

— When repetition is NOT allowed, then the # = $\frac{n!}{(n-k)!}$

where $n! = n \cdot (n-1) \cdot (n-2) \cdot \dots \cdot 2 \cdot 1$

(e.g. in the book case example, $n=3$, $k=3$)

▮ Combination : An unordered arrangement of k objects out of n objects.

★ Repetition is NOT allowed in a combination problem.

$$\# \text{ of ways} = \binom{n}{k} = \frac{n!}{k! (n-k)!}$$